The operations went well for India in the central sector, with 7 Infantry Division completing its task by 11 September. On 10 September, the division's 4 SIKH captured Barkee, located on Lahore's eastern outskirts.

In the southern sector, Major General Gurbaksh Singh's 4 Mountain Division found the going difficult as it was tasked both with capturing Pakistani territory east of Ichhogil and also with containing possible enemy attacks on the Khem Karan–Kasur axis. The division gained some initial success, but on 8 September its advance was blunted by the counter-offensive conducted by Pakistan's 1 Armoured Division towards Jandiala Guru, Beas Bridge and Harike, an operation intended as an enveloping move to destroy XI Corps. This forced 4 Mountain Division to occupy a hastily prepared sector in Area Asal Uttar. The defended sector had approximately 3½ battalions of infantry along with 2 (Independent) Armoured Brigade and artillery deployed in the Chittikhui–Valtoha area. Fierce battles raged on for two days during which Indian forces repelled repeated attacks by Pakistani armour and infantry.



Indian Army troops prepare to give covering fire to the advancing forces in the Lahore sector. The aim of the Indian offensive in the Punjab sector was to make the Pakistani Army recoil and prevent it from reinforcing its operations in the Akhnur sector. (© Hulton-Deutsch Collection/CORBIS/Corbis via Getty Images)